

Case Study: Phishing Attack on College Students

Phishing is a cybercrime in which attackers impersonate a trusted entity to steal sensitive information such as passwords, bank details, or personal data. A common real-world example is email-based phishing, widely reported by organizations like [Cyber Crime India Portal](#).

In a typical scenario, the attacker first creates a fake email that appears to be from a legitimate source, such as a university or bank. Step one involves sending this email to multiple users, often with urgent language like “Your account will be suspended.” Step two includes a link to a fake website that closely resembles the official one. Step three occurs when the victim clicks the link and enters their login credentials, unknowingly submitting them to the attacker. Finally, the attacker uses these details to access accounts or commit financial fraud.

Students are frequent targets because they often check emails regularly and may lack awareness of such threats. New students, in particular, may trust emails related to admissions, scholarships, or exam notifications.

The consequences can be severe. Victims may lose money, have their personal data misused, or face identity theft. In academic settings, compromised accounts can also lead to data breaches affecting entire institutions. This highlights the importance of digital literacy, verifying email sources, and avoiding suspicious links.